

The Resolution

For submission to FCSSAA by a member FCSS program or municipal council

Deadline: noon, Saturday, September 26, 2026 · director@fcssaa.org Vote: FCSSAA Annual General Meeting, November 25, 2026

Topic: Disability Income as Prevention — Protecting Community Wellbeing Through Adequate Disability Income Support

BE IT RESOLVED THAT the Family and Community Support Services Association of Alberta call on the Government of Alberta to ensure that disability income assistance — under both the Assured Income for the Severely Handicapped (AISH) and the Alberta Disability Assistance Program (ADAP) — provides income that meets or exceeds the Market Basket Measure (Canada’s official poverty line) together with the additional costs of living with a disability; preserves the full value of the federal Canada Disability Benefit without an offsetting reduction in provincial benefits; maintains access to health and disability-related benefits regardless of a person’s employment income; and is designed so that it prevents, rather than shifts, avoidable hardship onto municipal and community-based preventive services.

RATIONALE

Family and Community Support Services exist to strengthen individuals, families, and communities through prevention. When people fall into poverty, housing instability, food insecurity, or isolation, the demand lands on community-based and FCSS-funded services. Adequate, stable disability income is one of the most direct preventive supports available, because it keeps people out of the crises those services are built to address.

People with disabilities carry costs other Albertans do not: disability-related transportation, assistive technology, medical supplies, specialized supports, and accessibility. Income support should therefore be measured against the Market Basket Measure plus those additional costs. As of the 2026 benefit period, the Government of Alberta reports a core ADAP financial benefit of \$1,740 per month; beginning in the August 2026 benefit period, two adults in the same household who

each receive disability income assistance each receive 88 per cent of the maximum individual benefit. Where disability income sits below the Market Basket Measure, or where the value of a federal disability benefit is reduced by a provincial offset, the predictable result is greater poverty, greater instability, and greater reliance on municipal and community services.

The government's published figures also show a trade-off in work incentives. An AISH recipient may keep only the first \$350 of monthly employment income before deductions begin, compared with \$700 under ADAP — and \$1,100 for an ADAP recipient with dependent children, or \$1,500 for a cohabiting partner under either program. A low earnings exemption limits how much a person can lift their own income through work, which runs against both employment participation and the prevention of poverty.

Independent research supports this approach. A 2026 University of Calgary School of Public Policy briefing paper finds that pairing adequate income security with higher earnings exemptions and meaningful employment supports is a more effective, evidence-based approach than reducing benefit levels, and a 2025 Disability Policy Research Program brief urges the province to stop treating the federal Canada Disability Benefit as non-exempt income.

When people with disabilities have income that meets their needs, stable supports, and a real path to participate in work and community life, they are far less likely to reach the point of crisis. Protecting disability income is therefore not outside the FCSS mandate — it is the clearest expression of it.

Note for the sponsoring council or FCSS board

This resolution is written to meet FCSSAA's three tests: it addresses one clear concern (adequacy and protection of disability income), it has a direct impact on demand placed on FCSS-funded and community-based services, and it fits the FCSS prevention mandate. It follows the required BE IT RESOLVED / RATIONALE format.

Please keep it neutral and constructive on submission. It is written as a policy ask, not as criticism of any government or party, and the neutral version is the one that carries.

If it needs narrowing to pass, that is normal. The clawback line is the one we would

keep.

Sources for the statements above

- **ADAP core benefit (\$1,740/month), the 88% couple rate, and the earnings exemptions** (\$350 AISH; \$700 ADAP; \$1,100 ADAP with dependants; \$1,500 cohabiting partner): Government of Alberta, Alberta Disability Assistance Program page, alberta.ca — verified August 2026.
- **Market Basket Measure:** Statistics Canada's official poverty line.
- **Income security paired with employment supports and higher earnings exemptions:** Jardine, Fyie and Zwicker, *Reforming Disability Income Support in Alberta for Employment and Equity*, University of Calgary School of Public Policy, Briefing Paper Vol. 19:07, June 2026 (HSP140), policyschool.ca.
- **The Canada Disability Benefit clawback:** lived-experience brief led by Brittany Finlay, University of Calgary Disability Policy Research Program, July 2025, dipo.ca/updates/aish-cdb-brief.

Free to adapt and submit. No attribution required.

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